KELLY'S ICE CREAM · MOUNT BETHEL, PENNSYLVANIA

Website redesign plan

Turn an outdated website into a high-performing local landmark: part ice cream destination, part family gathering place, and part gateway to the Delaware River, Water Gap, and Slate Belt.

Recommended strategic position

Homemade here. Worth the stop.

MODERN FARMHOUSE DIRECTION

Comprehensive strategy · October 2026

PLAN AT A GLANCE

The redesign should sell the stop, not just show the shop

Kelly's already has the ingredients visitors want: small-batch ice cream made on-site, a full food menu, a family-friendly setting, and a location tied to outdoor recreation. The new site should turn those strengths into quick decisions and measurable visits.

Be immediately useful

Put today's hours, directions, menu, featured flavors, and cake ordering within one tap on mobile.

Own the local story

Connect Kelly's to Route 611, the Delaware River, the Water Gap, and Slate Belt heritage without becoming a generic tourism site.

Make updates easy

Use structured menu and seasonal content that staff can edit without rebuilding a PDF or calling a developer.

Five priorities for version 1

1. **Mobile-first homepage.** The first screen answers what, where, when, and why.
2. **Structured live menu.** Categories, dietary notes, seasonal availability, and a print view.
3. **Visit planner.** Directions, parking, hours, accessibility, and “make a day of it” itineraries.
4. **Local search foundation.** Consistent business data, schema, focused pages, and review integration.
5. **Conversion tracking.** Measure calls, directions, menu use, cake inquiries, and ordering.

> **Recommended build path:** a lightweight, custom WordPress block theme on managed hosting, with minimal plugins and role-based editing. Use Squarespace only if lower setup complexity outweighs structured menu flexibility.

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CURRENT-STATE AUDIT

The site is hiding Kelly's strongest advantages

The current public content communicates authentic strengths, but its presentation and maintenance model make the business look less current than it is.

Observed condition	Business effect	Redesign response
Homepage is largely one long introduction	Key tasks are not prioritized for a visitor making a fast mobile decision.	Task-first hero, persistent utility bar, scannable sections.
Public menu is a 2021 PDF	Customers may question prices or availability; search engines cannot use the content well.	CMS-based menu as the primary source; auto-generated print version.
Attractions page is mainly a link list	It sends visitors away before explaining why Kelly's belongs in their trip.	Curated, activity-based itineraries with Kelly's as the meal/treat stop.
Public search result surfaced an "Untitled" page label	Weakens trust and click-through potential.	Unique page titles, descriptions, social preview images, schema.
Public URLs surfaced as HTTP	May create inconsistent canonical URLs or trust issues if redirects are incomplete.	Verify certificate, force HTTPS, set canonicals, redirect every legacy URL.
Broad offer is buried in prose	Food, ice cream, cakes, dietary options, and seasonal items compete rather than guide.	Clear product hierarchy and category landing pages.

What to preserve

- ✓ "Made on-site" proof point
- ✓ 50+ hard ice cream flavors
- ✓ Local favorites and broad choice
- ✓ Full food menu for a real meal stop
- ✓ Family-and-friends warmth
- ✓ Connection to river, Gap, Poconos, and Slate Belt

What to retire or rebuild

- PDF-first menu experience
- Unprioritized blocks of copy
- Unverified or dated attraction information
- Inconsistent hours across third-party listings
- Generic "welcome" language ahead of the value proposition
- Any legacy pages without a clear owner

Discovery requirement: before design begins, run a complete technical crawl and inventory all current URLs, forms, analytics, hosting, email dependencies, redirects, and third-party profiles. The public-text review supports this plan but is not a substitute for account-level access.

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

The region already brings the right customers past Kelly's door

Outdoor recreation and food are natural companions. Kelly's should meet visitors in the planning moment, then give them a compelling reason to stop on Route 611.

70k
APPROX. PARK ACRES
The Delaware Water Gap National Recreation Area spans a large cross-state outdoor landscape.

40
RIVER MILES
The Middle Delaware scenic river segment sits within the recreation area.

16.6m
REGIONAL TRIPS
Discover Lehigh Valley reported 16.6 million day and overnight trips in its FY2023-24 report.

$2.5b+
2024 VISITOR SPEND
Reported across the Lehigh Valley; recreation and food were major categories.

Figures are regional context, not a forecast of Kelly's revenue. Sources [4], [6], [7].

Priority audiences

Audience	Need state	Winning message
Local families	Dinner, treat, easy outing	Reliable favorites, something for everyone
River and trail visitors	Reward, refuel, cool down	Homemade ice cream minutes from the adventure
Day-trippers	Authentic local stop	A place worth building into the route
Slate Belt residents	Community gathering	Locally made, locally loved
Cake buyers	Confidence and convenience	Clear sizes, lead times, designs, inquiry path

Seasonal moments to own

Spring
Opening energy, trail season, school and sports celebrations.

Summer
River days, campground traffic, family outings, evening treats.

Fall
Scenic drives, foliage, harvest flavors, post-hike meals.

Winter
Cakes, take-home treats, gift cards, community storytelling.

> Kelly's does not need to compete as “another ice cream shop.” It can own the role of the homemade stop between the Slate Belt, the river, and the Gap.

One promise can serve both locals and visitors

RECOMMENDED POSITION

Homemade here. Worth the stop.

Kelly's is the friendly Route 611 gathering place where more than 50 flavors of hard ice cream are made on-site - a satisfying stop for local families, river days, scenic drives, and Slate Belt adventures.

Proof

- Made on-site in small batches
- 50+ hard ice cream flavors
- Food for lunch or dinner
- Longstanding local connection

Personality

- Warm, unpretentious
- Generous and practical
- Proudly local
- Playful, never childish

Emotional payoff

- The reward after an adventure
- An easy family yes
- A taste of the area
- A reason to linger

Message hierarchy

1. **What:** Homemade ice cream and fresh, casual food.
2. **Why Kelly's:** More than 50 hard flavors made on-site.
3. **Why now:** Open today, seasonal feature, or easy cake order.
4. **Why here:** A Route 611 stop near the Delaware River and Water Gap.
5. **What next:** View menu, get directions, order a cake.

Sample headline bank

Homepage: Homemade ice cream for the road, the river, and right here at home.

Tourism: End the adventure with a scoop.

Menu: More than a cone - lunch, dinner, shakes, sundaes, and 50+ homemade flavors.

Cakes: Made here for your next reason to celebrate.

Language guardrail: lead with Kelly's own facts and hospitality. Use the region as context, not borrowed prestige. Avoid claiming to be “the official” stop, using protected park marks, or implying formal partnerships unless agreements exist.

VISUAL DIRECTION

Modern farmhouse should feel local, not generic

The design language should combine clean utility with materials and colors that belong to this landscape: cream paper, river green, slate gray, warm wood, and a small rust accent.

River green	Slate	Warm wood	Barn rust	Cream
#2F5748	#43504C	#B88958	#9B4D35	#F4EFE4

Design system

- **Typography:** a sturdy editorial serif for headlines with a clean sans serif for navigation, menu data, and calls to action.
- **Layout:** generous whitespace, clear rules, asymmetrical editorial moments, and disciplined grids.
- **Texture:** subtle paper grain, slate lines, and wood-toned details - never faux shiplap everywhere.
- **Shapes:** mostly square and practical, with occasional softened corners inspired by scoops.
- **Icons:** simple line drawings for cone, burger, cake, river, trail, and directions.

Photography leads the brand

Use original, naturally lit images with real staff and customers. Hero images should show the product and the place together, not anonymous stock cones.

- Real scoops
- Hands at work
- Route 611 arrival
- Family tables
- River-day gear
- Seasonal details

Homepage art direction

HERO

A wide, candid photo of a signature cone or sundae in the foreground, with Kelly's exterior or outdoor seating identifiable behind it.

CRAFT PROOF

Close-up sequence: batch making, scooping, toppings, finished product. Keep stainless equipment honest and clean.

PLACE PROOF

Customers arriving with bikes, paddles, or hiking gear where authentic. Include locals and ordinary family moments.

> **Guardrails:** avoid generic barn logos, distressed fonts, red gingham overload, staged “country” props, stock waterfalls, or dark rustic tones that dull the food. Keep the name recognizable, use strong contrast and visible focus states, and never convey meaning by color alone.

Six primary choices can cover every important journey

Menu | Flavors | Cakes | Plan your visit | Explore the area | Our story

Primary page	What it must contain	Primary action
Home	Value proposition, open status, highlights, proof, local context	View menu / Directions
Menu	Food, ice cream, drinks, dietary notes, price and availability notices	Choose what to order
Flavors	Current hard flavors, soft serve, seasonal rotation, allergen disclaimer	Find a favorite
Cakes	Sizes, serving guide, designs, lead time, pickup, inquiry/order path	Start an order
Plan your visit	Hours, address, directions, parking, seating, accessibility, contact	Get directions / Call
Explore the area	Curated itineraries, activity types, current official links, safety note	Build a day trip
Our story	Local history, ice cream process, team, community involvement	Trust the brand

Three critical customer journeys

Hungry now Search / map	**Home** Open + menu	**Menu** Decision	**Directions** Store visit
Planning a day Area search	**Local guide** Choose activity	**Kelly's stop** Meal or treat	**Directions** Route 611
Celebrating Cake search	**Cakes** Size + options	**Inquiry** Details	**Pickup** Confirmed

Persistent mobile actions

Use a compact bottom utility bar for **Menu**, **Directions**, and **Call**. Keep ordering separate unless the operational workflow is ready.

Footer essentials

Address, phone, current hours, social links, accessibility statement, privacy, employment, contact, and last menu update.

The homepage should answer five questions in one screenful

KELLY'S Menu · Flavors · Cakes · Visit · Explore

Homemade ice cream for the road, the river, and home.

VIEW MENU

50+ hard flavors made on-site · Mount Bethel, PA

OPEN TODAY
Verified hours

GET DIRECTIONS
Route 611

CALL
One tap

What are you craving?
Ice cream · Food · Shakes & sundaes · Cakes

Made here, one batch at a time
Process proof + real photography + story link

Make Kelly's part of the day
River · Trail · Scenic drive · Slate Belt itinerary cards

Local love
Selected reviews + community proof + gallery

Celebrate with a Kelly's cake
Serving guide + lead time + start order

Above-the-fold checklist

- ✓ What Kelly's is
- ✓ What makes it different
- ✓ Open/closed status
- ✓ Mount Bethel location
- ✓ Menu and directions actions

> **Hero rule:** never hide hours, address, or calls to action inside a rotating slideshow. One strong image and one clear message are more effective.

Content order rationale

1. Utility before storytelling
2. Choice before detail
3. Proof before claims
4. Local context before external links
5. Celebration offer before footer

Homepage modules to keep dynamic

- Today's hours
- Featured flavor
- Seasonal notice
- Event / closure
- Cake lead time

> **Homepage success test:** a first-time visitor should find today's hours, decide whether there is food for the group, and launch directions in under 30 seconds on a phone.

The menu must become searchable, current, and easy to maintain

The website should hold the authoritative menu data. A printable PDF may still exist, but it should be generated from the same source so prices and availability do not drift.

Recommended menu structure

Ice cream
Hard flavors, soft serve, frozen yogurt, no-sugar-added options, sizes, cones, toppings.

Creations
Sundaes, banana splits, shakes, flurries, floats, smoothies.

Food
Burgers, hot dogs, sandwiches, wraps, hoagies, paninis, salads, sides.

Take-home and celebrations
Cakes, sandwiches, novelties, packs, gift cards if offered.

Each item record should support

- ✓ Name and concise description
- ✓ Category and display order
- ✓ Current price or “market/seasonal” state
- ✓ Size and serving data
- ✓ Availability: daily, seasonal, limited
- ✓ Dietary indicators with disclaimer
- ✓ Photo only when it helps a decision
- ✓ Last reviewed date and staff owner

Allergen safety: icons should never promise an allergen-free environment. Publish a plain-language cross-contact statement and train staff on how website claims match in-store procedures.

Flavor experience

BROWSE
Search or filter by chocolate, fruit, nut, coffee, classic, seasonal, and dietary option.

DISCOVER
Feature 6-10 current favorites with real photography and simple flavor notes.

SET EXPECTATIONS
Use “typically available” and “while supplies last” where the case changes day to day.

Cake funnel

Choose size	Choose style	Add details	Confirm
Serving guide	Approved examples	Date + message	Staff follow-up

Do not launch payment or instant confirmation until production capacity, lead times, blackout dates, deposits, refunds, and pickup procedures are documented.

REGIONAL TOURISM HUB

A useful local guide can turn trip planning into store visits

Replace a directory of external links with a small set of curated itineraries. Each should answer who it is for, how long it takes, what to bring, and where Kelly's fits.

River day + cool-down

For paddlers, anglers, and families using river access. Position Kelly's as the food-and-treat stop before heading home.

Link only to official river conditions, safety, and access information.

Trail day + reward scoop

For hikers and Appalachian Trail visitors. Focus on easy planning, changing conditions, and a satisfying post-hike stop.

Avoid promising travel times until routes are verified.

Scenic Route 611 drive

For foliage, overlooks, and river-valley scenery. Tie the story to the Delaware River Valley Scenic Byway and rural character.

Slate Belt history + local flavor

For heritage-minded day-trippers. Connect Bangor, Portland, Mount Bethel, and slate history to an authentic local meal or treat.

Template for every itinerary

1. **Promise:** one-sentence reason to choose it.
2. **Fit:** families, adults, hikers, paddlers, rainy day.
3. **Duration:** half-day or full-day, verified seasonally.
4. **Official planning links:** conditions, fees, closures, safety.
5. **Kelly's stop:** the best point in the route and what to order.
6. **Local add-on:** one nearby small business or heritage site, with permission where needed.

Editorial rule: Kelly's should not duplicate changing park data. Summarize the experience, then point to the National Park Service for current conditions, river levels, closures, and safety.

Partnership actions

TOURISM LISTINGS

Join or refresh listings with Discover Lehigh Valley, tourism organizations, campground directories, and local chambers.

CROSS-PROMOTION

Create trackable offer cards or QR codes with campgrounds, outfitters, farms, wineries, and heritage organizations.

LOCAL AUTHORITY

Invite partners to review itinerary facts and share seasonal updates; credit them clearly.

Search visibility should follow real customer intent

Core search themes

Intent	Page to win it
Ice cream near Mount Bethel / Portland	Home + Plan your visit
Homemade ice cream near Delaware Water Gap	Home + Explore the area
Ice cream flavors / menu	Flavors + Menu
Ice cream cake near me	Cakes
Food after hiking / river trip	Itinerary pages
Family food Route 611	Menu + Plan your visit

Use natural language. Do not create thin pages for every town or repeat place names unnaturally.

Local search foundation

- ✓ One canonical business name, address, and phone
- ✓ Accurate regular and holiday hours
- ✓ Restaurant and LocalBusiness schema
- ✓ Menu URLs that search engines can crawl
- ✓ Strong title and description for every page
- ✓ Google Business Profile linked and maintained
- ✓ Review request process and response owner
- ✓ Legacy URL redirect map

First 12 content pieces

1. How Kelly's makes hard ice cream on-site
2. A river-day food and treat plan
3. A post-hike stop near the Water Gap
4. What makes black raspberry a local favorite
5. Route 611 scenic-drive itinerary
6. Slate Belt history day + local stops
7. Ice cream cake serving-size guide
8. Spring flavor preview
9. Summer family outing checklist
10. Fall foliage treat guide
11. Meet the maker / staff story
12. Holiday take-home and cake guide

> **Publishing cadence:** launch with four evergreen pieces and two seasonal pieces. After launch, publish or refresh one useful item each month, plus immediate updates for hours, closures, and menu changes.

On-page recipe

Clear title	Useful answer	Local proof	Next step
Real query	No filler	Original photos	Menu / directions

Fast, accessible, maintainable technology protects the investment

Recommended stack

Managed WordPress hosting, custom block theme, structured content types, server-side caching, image optimization, and automated backups.

Why it fits

Staff can update menu, hours, features, and guides without editing layouts. The ecosystem supports mature SEO and integrations.

Keep it lean

Avoid page-builder lock-in, plugin duplication, auto-playing video, oversized libraries, and features without an operational owner.

Version 1 requirements

Area	Requirement	Acceptance target
Performance	Optimized images, caching, minimal scripts	Core Web Vitals assessed on real mobile devices
Accessibility	Keyboard, labels, contrast, alt text, zoom	WCAG 2.2 AA review before launch
Security	HTTPS, least privilege, updates, backups	Daily backup and tested restore procedure
SEO	Metadata, schema, sitemap, redirects	No orphaned launch pages or broken legacy URLs
Analytics	Consent-aware events and campaign tags	Calls, directions, menu, cakes tracked
Editing	Role-based CMS and short field labels	Staff can update hours and a price unaided

Useful integrations

- Map directions link, not a heavy map on every page
- Instagram gallery only if it does not slow the site
- Email signup with a clear value proposition
- Ordering link when the provider and workflow are confirmed
- Spam-protected forms with delivery monitoring

Defer until justified

- Customer accounts or loyalty portal
- Complex custom ordering
- Live inventory for every flavor
- Automated attraction feeds
- Chatbots, animation-heavy effects, or app builds

> **Critical operational choice:** decide whether “order online” means food ordering, cake inquiry, cake payment, or all three. Each requires different ownership, confirmations, refund rules, and integrations.

CONTENT PRODUCTION

Original content is what makes the farmhouse brand credible

The site will only feel premium if the photographs, menu data, and local information are accurate. Treat content production as a workstream with owners and deadlines.

Priority photo shot list

1. Exterior approach and roadside identity
2. Hero cone or sundae with place context
3. Hard ice cream production process
4. Flavor case and scooping action
5. Signature burger, panini, wrap, or hoagie
6. Cakes: three sizes and design examples
7. Family and friend groups at tables
8. Staff portraits in real working moments
9. Outdoor seating, parking, and accessibility
10. Seasonal scene with river/trail cues

Production standards

- ✓ One full-day local shoot plus seasonal pickup shots
- ✓ Horizontal and vertical versions of key scenes
- ✓ Model releases where recognizable people appear
- ✓ Natural color; food must match in-store reality
- ✓ File naming by subject, not camera number
- ✓ Web exports plus archived high-resolution originals
- ✓ Alt-text notes captured during selection

Content inventory before writing

Input	Owner to assign	Definition of done
Menu master	Operations	Every item, price, size, availability verified
Hours calendar	Manager	Regular, seasonal, and holiday rules documented
Cake policy	Production	Sizes, lead times, deposits, pickup, change policy
Business facts	Owner	History, process, claims, names approved
Visitor facts	Marketing	Official source link and review date for each
Photo library	Marketing	Usage rights, captions, crops, alt text complete

Voice

Friendly, specific, and concise. Say “made on-site” rather than “artisanal.” Say what is fresh, local, or homemade only when the claim is documented.

Approval rule

One owner has final say on facts and offers. Copy, menu data, and photography receive one consolidated approval round before build.

A phased 12-week launch keeps version 1 focused

01

Discover and decide · Weeks 1-2

Stakeholder workshop, analytics and hosting access, customer questions, competitor review, URL inventory, menu workflow, ordering decision, success baseline.

02

Structure and produce · Weeks 3-4

Information architecture, wireframes, content model, photo brief, menu cleanup, cake policy, local itinerary research, redirect plan.

03

Design and write · Weeks 5-7

Two design directions, selected system, component library, full-page designs, final copy, photography, accessibility review.

04

Build and connect · Weeks 8-10

CMS theme, structured menu, forms, analytics, schema, performance tuning, content entry, redirects, staff roles.

05

Test and launch · Weeks 11-12

Device testing, content proof, accessibility checks, form delivery, backup restore test, staff training, DNS launch, 72-hour monitoring.

Choose the right scope tier

Tier	Includes	Best when
Core	7 core pages, live menu, visit page, cakes inquiry, basic SEO	Speed and essentials matter most
Growth	Core + tourism hub, photography, 6 launch articles, advanced tracking	Kelly's wants regional discovery
Flagship	Growth + ordering integration, expanded cake flow, partner campaigns	Operations can support digital demand

> **Procurement advice:** ask three vendors to price the same written scope, hosting, content entry, migration, training, accessibility review, warranty period, and monthly maintenance. Compare ownership and operating cost, not just launch price.

Do not cut

Mobile UX, menu migration, redirects, accessibility, analytics, staff training, backups.

Safe to defer

Online payment, loyalty accounts, elaborate animation, live flavor inventory, custom trip maps.

Success is store intent, not page views alone

Visibility

- Local search impressions
- Branded vs. non-branded visits
- Map profile actions
- Itinerary landing visits

Engagement

- Menu views and category use
- Flavor searches
- Return visitor rate
- Content-to-menu paths

Conversion

- Direction clicks
- Phone clicks
- Cake inquiries
- Ordering starts/completions

90-day learning plan

1. **Before launch:** record current search, traffic, profile, and inquiry baselines where available.
2. **Week 1:** confirm indexing, redirects, forms, event tracking, and business listings.
3. **Day 30:** review top landing pages, searches, mobile behavior, and menu exits.
4. **Day 60:** improve weak calls to action and publish the next seasonal guide.
5. **Day 90:** compare direction, call, cake, and ordering behavior to baseline; set quarterly targets.

Operating cadence

Daily/when needed: closures, sold-out notices, urgent hours.

Weekly: featured flavors, events, form delivery check.

Monthly: analytics, broken links, content refresh.

Quarterly: menu audit, accessibility spot-check, partner links.

Annually: full technical, content, and privacy review.

Ownership matrix

Responsibility	Primary owner	Backup
Hours and urgent notices	Store manager	Shift lead
Menu and price data	Operations lead	Owner
Cakes and inquiries	Cake/production lead	Manager
Stories and tourism pages	Marketing owner	Agency
Security and updates	Web partner	Managed host
Analytics review	Owner/marketing	Web partner

> **Launch definition:** the project is complete only when staff can update hours, prices, featured flavors, and an alert without developer help - and when a tested backup can restore the site.

Grounded plan, with operational facts still to confirm

Public sources reviewed

1. **Kelly's Ice Cream homepage.** Current public positioning, product breadth, local-area language. kellysicecream.com
2. **Kelly's 2021 menu PDF.** Product categories, cakes, drinks, food, and legacy pricing structure. Public menu PDF
3. **Kelly's area attractions page.** Current outbound-link approach and listed attractions. Area attractions
4. **National Park Service.** Delaware Water Gap activities, planning, current conditions, river information, and safety categories. Plan your visit
5. **National Park Service science overview.** Approximate acreage, landscape, and recreation context. Park natural resources
6. **Discover Lehigh Valley FY2023-24 annual report.** Regional trip and spending context. Annual report
7. **Lehigh Valley Public Media.** Reported 2024 visitor spending, recreation, and food-and-beverage context. 2024 tourism report coverage
8. **Lower Mount Bethel Township.** Delaware River Valley Scenic Byway corridor, Route 611, rural character, recreation, and economic-development context. Corridor management plan
9. **Plan Slate Belt.** Heritage and outdoor-recreation economic-development priorities. Steering committee materials

Confirm before content lock

- ✓ Current regular and seasonal hours
- ✓ Every item, price, size, and availability
- ✓ Current number of hard flavors
- ✓ Soft serve, yogurt, dietary options
- ✓ Mini golf status and operating details
- ✓ Cake sizes, lead times, deposit policy
- ✓ Food and cake ordering workflow
- ✓ Parking, seating, accessibility, pets
- ✓ Official social profiles and review links
- ✓ Brand, photography, and testimonial rights

Decisions needed in kickoff

1. Core, Growth, or Flagship scope?
2. Who owns menu data after launch?
3. Is online ordering part of version 1?
4. Will cakes be inquiry-only or paid online?
5. Which current logo elements must remain?
6. Which three local partners should launch with the tourism hub?
7. Who approves facts and final content?

> **Assumptions in this plan:** Kelly's remains at the public address shown online; homemade hard ice cream and the broad food offer remain core; the preferred aesthetic is modern farmhouse; and regional tourism growth is a priority. All operating details require owner confirmation.

Recommended next move

Run a two-hour discovery workshop, select the **Growth** scope, assign a menu owner, and commission the photo shoot and content inventory before visual design begins.